

# How to harness AI

to create stunning product photos  
for websites, ads and social media



Styloquin<sup>®</sup>

Nano Banana is a codename the Google developers gave to the image generation app for Gemini. Gemini flash 2.5 is the official name, but all the cool kids still call it Nano Banana.

Nano Banana is an AI tool that uses plain text, called prompts, to create images. The more focused and descriptive your prompt is, the more likely you are to get the image you're trying to create.

Nano Banana is free to use, though free usage is limited. To get started, go to [gemini.google.com](https://gemini.google.com) and sign up for a free account. The free account will give you about three to five free images each day. Each edit counts as an image so it's pretty easy to burn through the free credits. A subscription is about \$20/month.

Creating product photos with Nano Banana is both magical and frustrating. When you nail it, the resulting image is a joy to behold. A few sentences and "Voilà!" a stunning image you can use for ads, emails, websites and social media. No photographer, no wait, just WOW!

The flip side is, if you don't nail it on the first go, it can be a hair pulling experience to get what you want. (I'm going to help you avoid that part.)

I started my career as a professional photographer and for 15 years shot everything from china and sterling, to industrial shaker tables, food, and a lot of people smiling and shaking hands. I then switched to art direction and worked for and with companies like L.L. Bean, International Paper, Mrs. Beasleys, and Harrington's of Vermont.

AI generated images have fascinated me from the beginning and, even with a background in photography and art direction, it has not always gone according to plan. The good news is you don't have to start from the beginning like I did, and once you understand the basics, you can get great results quickly.

In this guide I will walk you through how to structure your prompt, what to include, and how to reset when things don't turn out the way you want them too.

*Pro Tip: Once you've created stunning product images with AI, Stylaquin helps shoppers engage with them longer. Beautiful images in Stylaquin's Look Book format can increase product views by 104% and boost conversions by 41%. Learn more on page 9.*



Denslow Dry Goods upgraded their product images with AI. These show off the Pillow collection. The original images of the pillows (left) were silhouetted images created in Printify.



# The Core 5:

## What Nano Banana Needs

These are the non-negotiables. Without these, the AI has to guess, and it often guesses wrong.

AI can't see the image in your head, so you must be specific about what you want, or you'll get random results. This can be good, if you aren't sure what you want and you don't care about a specific outcome, or if you just want to get your creative juices flowing. Let's say you want an image of someone looking at an overflowing closet with nothing to wear. The image just needs to look frustrating and a bit out of control. But if you want a specific image, you need to be specific about what you ask for. Being hyper-specific takes some getting used to, so when you start out, use the handy Perfect Prompt Worksheet at the end of this guide. Think through the shot and start with these five must have descriptions.

## The Subject

### (What is it?)

If you're creating a product shot, you need to start by saying you want to create a product shot and give Nano Banana a reference. Let's say you want to show a new pair of slippers in a home situation, but all you have is the manufacturers shot of the slippers on a white background. (This is known as a silhouette, or silo.) You need to give Nano Banana the silo as a reference, as well as specific instructions. The more specific you are the more likely you are to get the outcome you want. If you want a product shot with the slippers as the hero, you need to say that. If you want to show a woman lounging by a fire, you need to say that. The subject tells Nano Banana what to focus on.

## The Environment

### (Where is it?)

A product floating in white space looks like a clip-art icon. A product in a "place" looks like a photograph. The more information you provide about where your product is, the closer the result will be to your expectations.

*Prompt Tip: "holding a cup of coffee in a sunlit kitchen" or even better, "woman holding a rustic mug of coffee in a cozy sunlit log cabin setting with mountains showing through the window and a Bernese Mountain Dog puppy sleeping at her feet."*

## The Lighting

### (How is it lit?)

Lighting dictates the mood and realism. Bad lighting is the #1 reason AI images look "fake. If you want the product to look like it's in a large store, you need to say that and specify overhead lighting. If you want it to look like it's in a home environment specify soft lighting, window lighting, light falling from an overhead light with a spill of natural light from a window that is on the right but out of frame.

*Prompt Tip: Keywords like "golden hour," "soft window light" (for natural/organic products), or "studio neon lighting" (often used for tech/gaming products).*

## The Medium/Style

### (What kind of image is this?)

Nano Banana can create a 3D render, a watercolor painting, or a sketch. You need to tell it to be a camera. Sounds super obvious, but to a machine that can do anything from anime, to a child's drawing style, to impressionism, it's a basic starting point.

*Prompt Tip: For product photography use "High-resolution professional product photography", "macro lens shot" (if you want a closeup), or "4k DSLR." to get super clear, high resolution output.*

## The Composition

### (How is it framed?)

This controls where the product sits in the image. Imagine it your mind's eye. Are you looking down on it? Are you looking straight at it? You can tell Nano Banana how much or how little background to show in the image. Telling Nano Banana to "shoot from eye-level, crop in tight, and make the background out of focus" gets you the classic hero product shot.

*Prompt Tip: "Eye-level shot," "top-down flat lay" (great for organizing items), or "close-up low angle."*



# The “Pro” 5: The Secret Sauce

These details turn a “good” image into a “brand-ready” image. Once you get the hang of creating prompts with the 5 must-haves we covered earlier, these five pro tips will help you really dial it in so they will work in different formats and will showcase your brand. Remember, while AI is amazing, it is also new to your project every time. Kind of like the movie 50 First Dates. It may seem like it remembers, but it doesn’t, so you will have to give it your brand colors and specifics every time.

Do not give it your logo. It amazes me that it can take a product image and recreate it perfectly (though you always have to check) and yet it is very bad at adding a logo. I asked Nano Banana why that is and it said it doesn’t do a good job with text or specific graphic elements like logos. If you need to add a logo, it’s easy to create templates with layers in any design program, then just add a logo on a separate layer from the image.

## Mood & Vibe (Target Customer)

This is where you use your target customer data. Think about who this image needs to connect with, outdoor adventures, sophisticates, active seniors, etc.

Instead of saying “for Gen Z,” describe the vibe that appeals to them: “Y2K aesthetic, vibrant pink and acid green colors, playful energy.”

Instead of “for professionals,” use: “sleek, minimalist, desaturated tones, organized.”

You need to describe the environment that will be most attractive to your audience. You can say “’70s groovy vibe with bold colors and curvy lines.” Don’t say “Like the artist Peter Max” That is a copyright infringement.

## Negative Prompts (What to avoid)

Sometimes it helps to tell Nano Banana what not to do. It’s hard to think of what you don’t want in the first try at a new image. Nano Banana does a pretty good job of editing things out once you tell it what to take out. It’s worth thinking about obvious things you don’t want in the beginning.

Example: “No text, no humans, no blurry background, no distortion.”

## Aspect Ratio (What size)

Nano Banana will output whatever it wants unless you tell it to give you a specific size. Because the output is in pixels it’s easier to provide an aspect ratio than it is to give it dimensions. Nano Banana does not do well with dimensions. Square images (1:1) are fine for Instagram, but terrible for a website banner. I have provided a cheat sheet for the most used aspect ratios at the end of this guide.

Nano Banana outputs high-resolution images suitable for web and social media. Right-click to save, or use the download icon.

*Tip: Specify “Wide 16:9 aspect ratio” for banners or “Tall 9:16” for Stories/TikTok.*

## Brand Color Palette (Your colors)

Nano Banana can understand color codes or specific color names. If you have specific brand colors you should provide them as Hex codes ( # and six numbers or letters.) Canva or Adobe Express are good places to find the hex codes for specific colors.

*Tip: “The background should be a soft pastel pink (Hex #FFD1DC)” or “featuring accents of electric blue.”*

## Reference Images

You can often upload a photo of your actual product and ask Nano Banana to “place this product in a [scene].” Check carefully that the rendered image matches what you uploaded. AI hallucinates—meaning it invents details that weren’t in your reference—and makes up things. If it goes wrong the first time, start over and re-upload the image. It often helps to give the image a new name before uploading it the second time. Limit the number of reference images you give Nano Banana. The more you give it, the more likely it is to make mistakes.

*Tip: This is the most powerful tool for stores. It ensures the AI doesn’t hallucinate a different version of their product. Less is typically more, but experiment.*

# Quick Summary

Think like a photographer, not a writer. Tell it what the camera sees (“soft light hitting a blue bottle on a beach”). Try to be specific and structured in how you describe the image you want. Avoid referring to famous artist’s work unless the work is over 120 years old, which puts it in the public domain. So don’t say “Make it look like a Richard Avedon image”, that’s copyright infringement and doesn’t respect the artist’s right to their work or their brand.

# Three Prompts, Three Different Results

Let's look at how actual prompts match output. For this example we'll try to create an inspiring image of Air Jordans for a social media post.

## Prompt 1 (Too Vague)

Prompt text: "A photo of air jordans in a locker room."

**The Result:** Nano Banana didn't know this was supposed to be a product shot. Honestly, for a prompt with almost no information, it's pretty impressive.



## Prompt 2 (Good start)

Prompt text: "A pair of Nike Air Jordan men's high top basketball sneakers, [Subject]. In a busy locker room with used towels and athletic bags. [Environment]. overhead lighting with some window light coming from a large window on the right that is out of frame. [Lighting]. High-resolution macro product photography, sharp focus on the sneakers [Style/Medium]. Modern, professional vibe [Mood]."

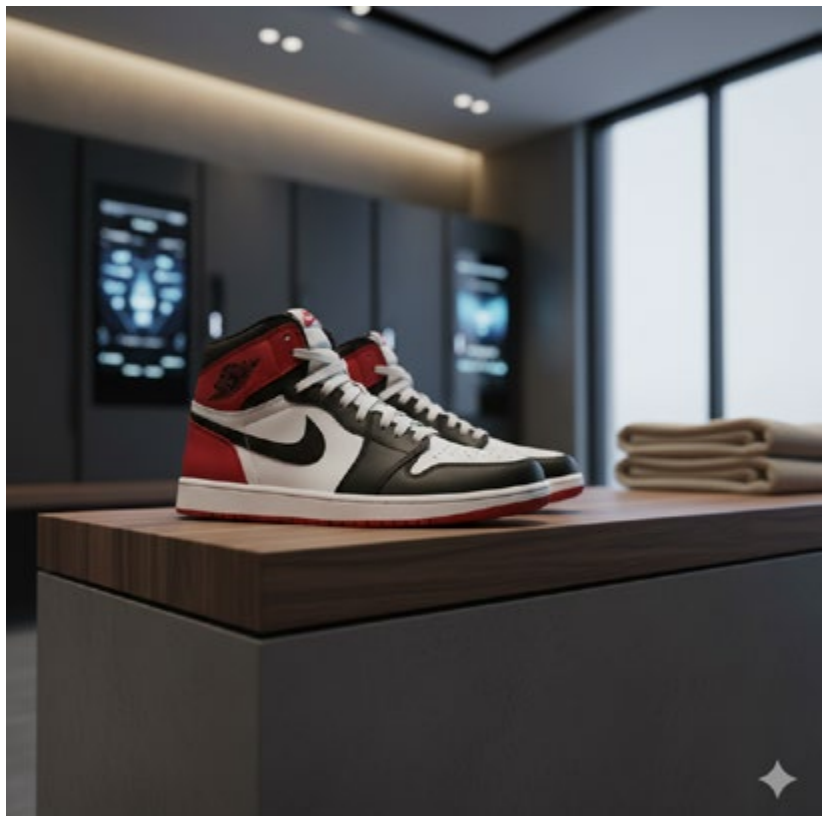
**The Result:** Better than the first prompt. It looks like an Air Jordan product shot, it has a "vibe" and it could work for a social media post on how having the right gear helps you reach your full potential.



## Prompt 3 (Strong Product image)

Prompt text: "Professional styled product shot of A pair of Nike Air Jordan men's high top basketball sneakers [Subject]. In a luxurious, tech-integrated, wellness-focused locker room with sleek, modern design and folded towels at the end of the bench. [Environment]. Soft hidden overhead lighting with some window light coming from a large window on the right that is out of frame. [Lighting]. High-resolution macro product photography, sharp focus on the sneakers and the background blurred out. Make sure the sneakers are visually separated from the background and the sneakers take up most of the image. [Style/Medium]. Modern, clean, high end profession athlete [Mood]."

**The Result:** This elevates the sneakers. Depending on your target audience that may, or may not, be the right direction. Notice that Nano Banana kept the shoes the same size even though the prompt specifically said to make them take up most of the image. It also changed the aspect ratio to square.



# How to recover when things go wrong

No matter what you do, no matter how carefully you prepare your prompt, at some point you will get a result that is not what you were looking for.

After the initial prompt you can give additional instructions and, for some things, it can work really well. Say you have a product image and the handbag that randomly appeared in the background needs to go. You can ask Nano Banana to remove the handbag and replace it with flowers. It might work perfectly. It might go very wrong.

After giving Nano Banana instructions that add to the original prompt, if you aren't happy, try changing one of the main characteristics of the image, like how the camera sees the image, the vibe or something fairly significant. If that fails, you'll need to start over.

Starting over is just part of the game. Telling Nano Banana to reduce the size of a pattern on a fabric will get you nowhere. If it has removed a part of a lapel or added zippers to something a few times, the AI is fried. Before you start throwing things, tell it to start over. It also helps to change the name of the reference image—make a copy and add a v2 to the end will work. If Nano Banana gets stuck, it often can't get itself unstuck. Tell it you want to start over, and change the prompt enough that it doesn't keep using the original image it created as the starting point.

The strength of Nano Banana's image capabilities is that it magically creates amazing images with very little information, the weakness is that it often stumbles on specific iterations and small changes.

If you get stuck, ask Nano Banana what to do. Seriously. One of the best ways to understand how to talk to AI is simply to ask questions.

Nano Banana does not do retouching well. It can remove backgrounds and then replace them, but it doesn't work well for fine tuning. If you need to retouch an image you will do better with Adobe Photoshop. Don't focus on details that don't matter. Remember that every photographer out there will shoot a different image of the same product, because every artist has a different vision. None of the big brands have matching images for every product. Don't get caught up in the fine detail, just start over.

## When to give up

If Nano Banana doesn't nail it within three tries, it probably isn't going to get it. Adjust the prompt and tell it to start over. If it's really getting stuck on something and just can't let go, you can start a new chat or wait a day or two and try it again. Nano Banana is a random image generator, so time does seem to change things. If you want the same look as a previous image, you should use that as a reference, but it may just limit what you get for output. Again—random image generator. The more you play, the better you'll become. Given how AI works, there is always going to be some magic to the output that you can't control.

## What the future holds

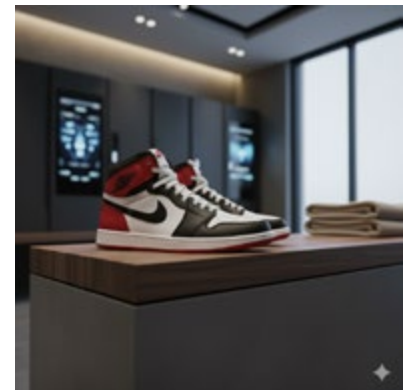
When PCs first came out, users had one floppy drive for the program and another for the project. Take a moment to revel in the wonder of how far we've come. Have fun with it. AI is in its infancy and it's only going to get better. You can't break it, so learn with the fearless enthusiasm of a child.



*First prompt didn't have enough separation between the sneakers and the lockers.*



*Second prompt added "Make sure the sneakers are visually separated from the background and the sneakers take up most of the image." Nano Banana got stuck and even though the prompt changed, the output didn't.*



*I told it to start over and gave it the second prompt again. It did a much better job of pulling the sneakers off the background. It also randomly changed the aspect ratio and made it a square because I didn't specify an aspect ratio in my prompt.*



# Adding a Background

I was able to create a new shot of a coat that had been cropped tightly. This is a good example of how to use Nano Banana to adjust styling for different target audiences.

It took several tries but I was able to get the image I wanted by:

1. Editing the prompt to correct the mistakes.
2. Starting over when Nano Banana hit a wall.
3. Adding a “2” to the reference image name and re-uploading it when I started over.

## First Prompt

*Use the reference image provided and create a photo showing the model wearing the jacket shown in the reference image, walking down the street in a quaint Maine village. Give the scene magic hour light. High resolution professional image. Show the model wearing white jeans, horizontal striped shirt and English riding boots. The model is happy and confident. 3:2 vertical. Keep the colors cool and muted so they don't overpower the jacket.*



Reference Image



First Image

*Wrong image orientation, Jacket is too short, collar notched, and there are too many buttons.*



## Final Prompt

*Start over. Use the reference image provided and create a photo showing the model wearing the jacket shown in the reference image, it should have a wide continuous collar without a notch. The model should be walking down the street in a quaint Maine village. Give the scene magic hour light. High resolution professional image. Show the model wearing white jeans, horizontal striped shirt and English riding boots. The jacket will be below knee length and cover the top of the boots. The model is happy and confident. 3:2 vertical. Keep the colors cool and muted so they don't overpower the jacket.*

# Perfect Prompt Worksheet

**The Subject**  
(What is it?)

**Mood & Vibe**  
(What the Target Likes)

**Sample Prompt:**

Core 5:

Use the reference image provided and create a photo showing the model wearing the jacket shown in the reference image, it should have a wide continuous collar without a notch. Show the model wearing white jeans, horizontal striped shirt and English riding boots. The jacket will fall below knee length and cover the top of the boots. [Subject and Reference]. The model should be walking down the street in a quaint Maine village. [Environment]. Give the scene magic hour light. [Lighting]. High resolution professional image. [Style/Medium].

Pro 5:

The model is happy and confident. [Mood & Vibe] No text [Negative Prompts] 3:2 vertical. [Aspect Ratio] Keep the colors cool and muted so they don't overpower the jacket [Color Palette]

**The Environment**  
(Where is it?)

**Negative Prompts**  
(What to avoid)

**The Lighting**  
(How is it lit?)

**Aspect Ratio**  
(What size)

**The Medium/Style**  
(What kind of image is this?)

**Brand Color Palette**  
(Your colors)

**The Composition**  
(How is it framed?)

**Reference Images**  
(Nothing copyrighted)



Reference  
Image  
Used:

## Most used Aspect Ratios

| Ratio, | Common Name,           | Primary Use Case                 |
|--------|------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 16:9,  | Widescreen,            | TVs, YouTube, Monitors           |
| 9:16,  | Vertical,              | TikTok, Reels, Stories           |
| 4:3,   | Standard / Fullscreen, | iPads, Old TV, Smartphone Photos |
| 3:2,   | 35mm,                  | Professional Photography (DSLR)  |
| 1:1,   | Square,                | Instagram Feed, Profile Pics     |
| 4:5    | Vertical Feed          | Facebook, LinkedIn               |



**Stylaquin**<sup>®</sup>

The easy way to get shoppers to stay longer, view more products, come back more often, and buy more when they do.



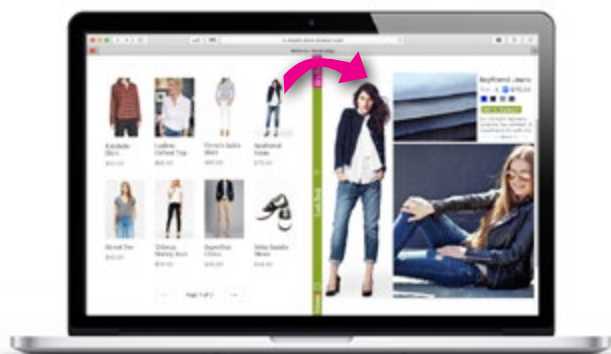
# Stylaquin® Makes Online Shopping Fun

Stylaquin is a Shopify app that adds a visual, shareable shopping experience that increases time on site, product views, return visits, and conversions.

## What Stylaquin shoppers do differently:

- **32%** longer session duration
- **104%** more products viewed
- **81%** more likely to return
- **41%** increase in conversion rate

Roughly 15% of new visitors and 25% of returning shoppers choose to shop with Stylaquin. That uplift tells Google shoppers live your site, which increases organic traffic. One store saw a 700% increase. Learn more at [Stylaquin.com/SEO](http://Stylaquin.com/SEO).

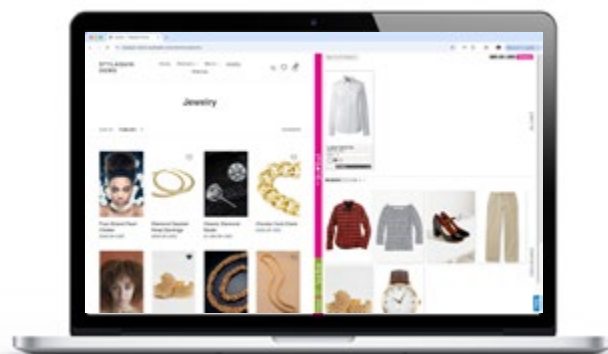


### The Look Book

Shoppers can flip through your site like a magazine by simply dragging products onto the Stylaquin bar. It's fast, immersive, and visually compelling.

**SEO-Lifting Engagement:** Every interaction increases time on site, product depth, and return visits—key signals Google uses to rank.

**Delight that increases conversions:** Stylaquin's Look Book makes shopping enjoyable, and sites have seen up to 41% more conversions from Stylaquin shoppers.



### The Idea Board

More than just a static wishlist. The Idea Board lets shoppers save, sort, and organize products with a Pinterest-like layout—shoppers create their own curated collections that are shareable and interactive.

**Share & Save:** Shoppers can create multiple boards, revisit them across devices, and share on social media and with friends.

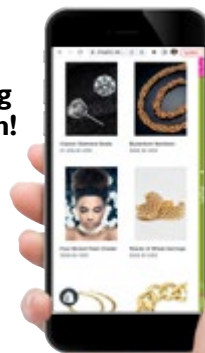
**Shop with Me:** Invite others to your board and shop together in real time. Perfect for friends, quilting groups, and sewing projects.

## Installs in about 15 minutes

- No theme changes or developer needed
- Easy to customize colors and fonts for your brand
- Test mode lets you deploy with confidence

Shoppers can explore visually, save, and even share curated boards. They stay longer, return more often, and buy more when they do.

**Makes  
mobile  
shopping  
more fun!**



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